AEGIS BANK

Leave Policy

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Document Information

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Approved By	**Sami Khan – Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Leave Policy is to establish a standardized framework governing employee leave entitlements, approval processes, documentation requirements, and responsibilities across Aegis Bank.

This policy promotes employee well-being while ensuring uninterrupted banking operations, regulatory compliance, and effective workforce planning.

The objectives of this policy are to:

- Support work-life balance.
- Ensure fair and consistent leave practices.
- Maintain operational continuity.
- Define leave approval procedures.
- Clarify employee and manager responsibilities.
- Ensure compliance with employment laws.

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2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Full-Time Employees
- Part-Time Employees
- Permanent Staff
- Probationary Employees
- Remote Employees
- Hybrid Employees

Contractors, consultants, interns, and temporary workers may be subject to separate contractual arrangements.

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3. Policy Statement

Aegis Bank recognizes that employees require planned and unplanned leave for personal well-being, medical needs, family responsibilities, and professional development.

Leave requests shall be managed fairly while ensuring customer service standards and operational requirements remain unaffected.

Leave approval is subject to:

- Business requirements
- Department staffing levels
- Operational priorities
- Applicable employment agreements

Submitting a leave request does not automatically constitute approval.

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4. Leave Principles

The Bank follows these guiding principles:

- Fairness and consistency.
- Transparency.

- Compliance with applicable laws.
- Business continuity.
- Respect for employee well-being.
- Accurate leave record management.

Managers should balance operational needs with employee welfare when reviewing leave requests.

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5. Types of Leave

5.1 Annual Leave

Eligible employees are entitled to paid annual leave based on their employment agreement.

Employees should:

- Submit requests in advance.
- Coordinate work handover.
- Obtain manager approval.
- Avoid peak operational periods unless approved.

Unused leave may be managed in accordance with HR guidelines and local legal requirements.

5.2 Sick Leave

Employees unable to work due to illness should:

- Notify their manager promptly.
- Record leave through the HR Management System.
- Provide medical documentation if required for extended absences.

The Bank may request a fitness-to-return certificate where appropriate.

5.3 Emergency Leave

Emergency leave may be granted for unforeseen situations, including:

- Serious illness of a family member
- Bereavement
- Natural disasters
- Personal emergencies
- Other exceptional circumstances approved by HR

5.4 Maternity Leave

Eligible employees may receive maternity leave in accordance with employment contracts and applicable laws.

Additional benefits may include:

- Flexible return-to-work arrangements.
- HR support during leave.
- Protection of employment rights during approved leave.

5.5 Paternity Leave

Eligible employees may request paternity leave following the birth or adoption of a child, subject to organizational policy.

5.6 Adoption Leave

Employees legally adopting a child may be eligible for adoption leave, supporting family integration while ensuring compliance with relevant regulations.

5.7 Compassionate Leave

Compassionate leave may be granted for:

- Death of an immediate family member.
- Critical family illness.
- Exceptional humanitarian circumstances.

Supporting documentation may be requested where appropriate.

5.8 Unpaid Leave

Unpaid leave may be approved in exceptional circumstances when paid leave balances have been exhausted or special situations arise.

Approval requires:

- Department Manager recommendation.
- Human Resources approval.
- Operational feasibility.

5.9 Study Leave

Employees pursuing approved professional certifications or higher education relevant to their role may request study leave.

Examples include:

- CAMS
- PMP
- CISSP
- AWS Certifications
- Banking Compliance Programs

Approval depends on business needs and learning objectives.

5.10 Jury Duty / Civic Leave

Where applicable by law, employees may receive leave for civic responsibilities such as jury duty or other legally mandated public service.

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6. Leave Request Procedure

Employees should follow these steps:

1. Submit the request through the HR Portal.
2. Select the appropriate leave category.
3. Attach supporting documentation if required.
4. Notify the reporting manager.
5. Await approval before commencing leave.
6. Ensure responsibilities are handed over.
7. Activate an out-of-office notification where applicable.

Emergency leave should be reported as soon as reasonably possible.

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7. Manager Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for:

- Reviewing leave requests promptly.
- Ensuring adequate staffing levels.
- Applying policies consistently.
- Maintaining fairness.
- Coordinating workload redistribution.
- Communicating approval or rejection clearly.

Managers should avoid unnecessary delays in leave decisions.

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8. Employee Responsibilities

Employees are expected to:

- Plan leave whenever possible.
- Submit accurate information.
- Avoid misuse of leave entitlements.
- Return to work on the approved date.
- Notify HR of any extension requests.

- Cooperate during workload handovers.

Misrepresentation of leave may result in disciplinary action.

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9. Leave During Probation

Employees serving a probationary period are expected to maintain regular attendance to support onboarding, training, and performance evaluation.

Leave during probation may be approved under genuine circumstances such as:

- Medical emergencies
- Family emergencies
- Bereavement
- Other exceptional situations approved by Human Resources

Annual leave during probation may be limited in accordance with employment agreements and applicable HR guidelines.

Frequent or unauthorized absences during probation may impact confirmation of employment.

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10. Public Holidays

Aegis Bank observes officially recognized public holidays applicable to the country or region in which employees are employed.

Employees required to work on designated public holidays due to operational requirements may receive:

- Alternative time off,
- Overtime compensation, or
- Other benefits,

subject to applicable laws and internal compensation policies.

Regional holiday schedules may differ across branch locations.

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11. Leave Extensions

If an employee is unable to return on the approved leave end date, they must:

- Inform their reporting manager immediately.
- Submit a leave extension request through the HR Portal.
- Provide supporting documentation where required.
- Await formal approval before extending leave.

Failure to obtain approval may result in the absence being treated as unauthorized.

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12. Unauthorized Absence

Unauthorized absence occurs when an employee:

- Fails to report for work without notification.
- Does not obtain required leave approval.
- Exceeds approved leave without authorization.
- Provides false information regarding leave.
- Repeatedly violates attendance requirements.

Unauthorized absences may result in:

- Verbal warning
- Written warning
- Salary deductions (where legally permitted)
- Performance review
- Disciplinary action
- Termination of employment for repeated or serious violations

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13. Leave Records

The Human Resources Department maintains accurate records of employee leave to ensure compliance with legal, regulatory, and organizational requirements.

Leave records include:

- Leave type
- Dates of absence
- Supporting documentation
- Approval history
- Remaining leave balance
- Return-to-work status

Employees may review their leave balances through the approved HR Management System.

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14. Compliance & Audit

Leave records may be reviewed during:

- Internal HR audits
- Regulatory inspections
- Compliance reviews
- Workforce planning activities
- Operational risk assessments

Managers and employees are expected to cooperate fully during any audit or review process.

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15. Exceptions

Exceptions to this policy may be approved only under exceptional business or personal circumstances.

Examples include:

- Critical medical emergencies
- Government directives
- Natural disasters
- Major operational disruptions
- Executive-approved business exceptions

Any exception must be documented and approved by the appropriate authority.

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16. Roles & Responsibilities

Human Resources

The Human Resources Department is responsible for:

- Maintaining this policy.
- Managing leave records.
- Providing policy guidance.
- Ensuring consistent policy implementation.
- Monitoring compliance.
- Supporting managers and employees.

Managers

Managers are responsible for:

- Reviewing leave requests fairly.
- Maintaining operational continuity.
- Planning workforce availability.
- Communicating leave decisions promptly.
- Escalating exceptional cases to HR.

Employees

Employees are responsible for:

- Following this policy.
- Submitting accurate leave requests.
- Providing required documentation.
- Returning to work on time.

- Reporting changes promptly.
- Maintaining honest communication.

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17. Practical Examples

Example 1 – Planned Annual Leave

An employee plans a two-week family vacation.

Correct Process

- Submit the request several weeks in advance.
- Obtain manager approval.
- Complete work handover.
- Activate an out-of-office notification.

Example 2 – Medical Emergency

An employee is hospitalized unexpectedly.

Correct Process

- A family member or the employee informs the manager as soon as possible.
- Submit medical documentation when available.
- HR updates the leave record.
- Return-to-work requirements are confirmed before resuming duties.

Example 3 – Unauthorized Leave

An employee fails to report to work for three consecutive days without notifying the manager.

Outcome

The absence is investigated under the Attendance and Disciplinary Procedures. Appropriate action is taken based on the circumstances and supporting evidence.

Example 4 – Leave Extension

An employee recovering from surgery requires additional recovery time beyond the approved leave period.

Correct Process

- Inform the manager before the leave expires.
- Submit updated medical documentation.
- Request an extension through the HR Portal.
- Wait for formal approval before extending the absence.

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18. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1. How early should I apply for annual leave?

Employees should submit requests as early as reasonably possible to support workforce planning and operational continuity.

Q2. Can my leave request be declined?

Yes. Leave requests may be declined or rescheduled if operational requirements or staffing constraints prevent approval during the requested period.

Q3. What happens if I become ill during annual leave?

Employees should notify their manager immediately and provide appropriate medical documentation. HR will determine whether adjustments to the leave record are applicable.

Q4. Can I cancel approved leave?

Yes, subject to manager approval and operational considerations.

Q5. What happens if I do not return after my approved leave ends?

Failure to return or request an extension may result in the absence being treated as unauthorized and may lead to disciplinary action.

Q6. Who approves my leave?

Approval authority depends on your reporting structure and the type of leave requested. In most cases, the Reporting Manager is the initial approver, with Human Resources involved where required.

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19. Related Documents

This policy should be read alongside:

- Employee Handbook (AB-HR-001)
- Code of Conduct Policy
- Remote Work Policy
- Attendance Policy
- Performance Management Policy
- Information Security Policy
- Business Continuity Policy

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20. Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Author
v1.0	January 15, 2026	Initial Release	Human Resources
v1.1	April 18, 2026	Updated Leave Categories & Approval Workflow	Human Resources
v1.2	**July 24, 2026**	**Enhanced Compliance Requirements, Remote Work Alignment, and Documentation Standards**	**Human Resources**

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21. Document Approval

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End of Document

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